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1. Briefly describe the idea that you have for your project and the problem that it attempts to solve. This does not need to include a great amount of detail, but it should be enough for your team to begin the process of idea generation and refinement.

Our project is a technology-driven platform designed to connect restaurants with homeless shelters, addressing the critical issues of food waste and food insecurity. The platform not only spreads awareness about the benefits and procedures of food donation by providing comprehensive checklists and educational resources but also guides users through the necessary steps to facilitate successful partnerships. Restaurants and shelters are assisted in the qualifying process through streamlined onboarding, which includes filling out essential forms and meeting specific criteria to ensure safety and compliance. Additionally, the platform offers customizable options that allow homeless shelters to specify their food preferences and requirements while enabling restaurants to filter and find shelters that match their capacity, type of food they can donate, and proximity. This intuitive system ensures that surplus food from restaurants is efficiently and safely redirected to those in need, fostering a collaborative community effort to reduce waste and support vulnerable populations. By simplifying the donation process and providing the necessary tools and guidance, the platform ensures that both restaurants and shelters can seamlessly engage in meaningful and sustainable food donation practices.

2. State what elements of your project fall under the “not-you” mindset, what your target audience is, and how your project meets the needs of this audience. Note that it should be clear that your project will adhere to the appropriate mindset as described above.

This project follows the “Not-You” mindset by prioritizing the needs of restaurant owners and homeless shelters with food donations. Restaurant owners need a streamlined way to donate surplus food without disrupting operations, while shelters require a reliable system to receive and distribute donations efficiently. The application addresses these needs by providing an intuitive platform where restaurant owners can quickly log donations, schedule pickups, and track contributions, while shelters can view available food, set preferences, and coordinate logistics. Real-time updates, scheduling tools, and inventory management ensure a seamless process, making food redistribution more efficient and reducing waste. By focusing on user needs, the project creates a practical solution that connects donors with recipients effectively.

3. Briefly describe the user interface that you plan on including in your project keeping in mind that some level of user interactivity will be required in your final project.

Our project will be built as a website, initially designed for a laptop browser view, with interactive elements such as text input fields and navigation buttons. The user interface will

include a homepage introducing the platform, an "About Us" page detailing our mission and goals, and an FAQ page with information on FDA regulations and donation procedures. A key feature of the website will be a form for restaurant representatives to fill out, allowing them to be matched with a shelter or food drive. Additionally, we will implement a login system that branches into two user flows based on account type—one for restaurants and another for homeless shelters—ensuring a tailored experience for both groups. To support accessibility and ease of use, we will also provide navigation links to shelters that are open to beta testing our platform.